incorporating a USD 1 billion line of credit, to support the development of Russia's Far East, through potential investments in Arctic projects, energy, and mining. The two governments agreed to establish a maritime corridor between Vladivostok and Chennai ports. These announcements made the important geopolitical point that India and Russia have shared economic and security interests in the Indo-Pacific.[1]

The outcomes of the Vladivostok Summit reaffirmed the conviction of India's foreign policy establishment that a deepening strategic relationship with the United States has to coexist with a robust partnership with Russia as India seeks to narrow its asymmetry of economic and military power vis-à-vis China.

There are four mutually reinforcing strands of the argument for India's close relations with Russia. The first is a legacy of the long-term collaboration with the Soviet Union and then Russia. Soviet/Russian-origin weapons and equipment today form the backbone of India's military capability. Even though this dependence is gradually being reduced, an abrupt shift from Russian to Western weapons systems would be expensive and would create defence vulnerabilities in the short to medium term. The second is geography. Russia straddles the Eurasian landmass adjacent to India's neighbourhood, where its actions impact India's political, economic, and consular interests. Good relations with Russia could influence some of these actions. This is particularly so in the case of China – a country which neighbours both India and Russia and with which both have a chequered history of interactions. A strong partnership with India could enhance Russia's resistance to Chinese pressures for acting against India's security interests. Third, there are attractive opportunities for economic and energy cooperation with Russia and its neighbours in Central Asia. The fourth strand is geopolitics: in an evolving post–Cold